NCE EXAM PREP

Practice Exam 16

Domain 4

Provision of Counseling Interventions

34 Practice Questions | 45 minutes

A, B, C answer choices

Answer Key and Explanations included

> **Instructions.** Select the single best answer for each question. Record your answers separately. This domain practice set is drawn from Full-Length Practice Exam 03. Use the suggested 45-minute practice timer. Do not consult Part B until you complete Part A. These domain timings are editorial practice allocations, not official NBCC section limits.

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PART A — QUESTIONS

Choose one answer (A, B, or C) per question.

Question 1

> The counselor uses the term “cognitive distortion.” The client looks confused and says, “I don’t know what that means, but I’m embarrassed to keep asking.”

What is the counselor’s best response?

A) Apologize for the jargon, explain the idea in plain language with the client’s example, and check whether it makes sense.

B) Give the client a glossary to review after the session so counseling time remains focused.

C) Continue using the term consistently because repeated exposure will make it familiar.

Question 2

> A client has just returned home after an emergency mental health evaluation and says the discharge plan “turned into a blur.” The client has the written plan, is currently stable, and wants help understanding what to do if distress rises again.

Which intervention is most appropriate?

A) Review the plan in short sections, connect each step to a likely situation, and ask the client to explain how the steps would be used.

B) Replace the clinical plan with a simpler plan created solely by the counselor.

C) Ask the client to reread the plan alone because changing its presentation could create confusion.

Question 3

> After making a minor mistake during a presentation, a client feels intense shame and wants to cancel a valued community event. The client agrees that withdrawing would likely deepen the shame and wants to act differently.

Which intervention best fits the situation?

A) Encourage the client to wait until the shame disappears before deciding about the event.

B) Help the client plan a manageable form of opposite action, such as attending briefly and engaging with one supportive person.

C) Ask the client to argue that the presentation mistake was actually a success.

Question 4

> A client corrects the counselor's pronunciation of the client's name for the third time and says, "I'm starting to think getting it right doesn't matter to you."

Which response best supports alliance repair?

A) "I work with many unfamiliar names, so I hope you can understand that mistakes happen."

B) "You have corrected me more than once, and I still got it wrong. I'm sorry. Please help me say it correctly now, and tell me how this has affected you."

C) "I do care, so I'll write the pronunciation in my notes and make sure we move forward."

Question 5

> After nearly every comment in group, a member looks at the leader and asks, "Was that okay?" Other members have begun waiting for the leader's judgment instead of responding to one another.

What is the leader's best intervention?

A) Reassure the member after each comment until enough confidence develops.

B) Stop responding to the member's questions so the behavior will extinguish.

C) Describe the approval-seeking pattern and invite the member and group to explore what happens when the leader does not evaluate each contribution.

Question 6

> A high school student is safe after peers circulated a humiliating altered image online. Notifications keep arriving, and the student says, "Every alert makes it start all over." The student wants help regaining control without losing possible evidence.

Which intervention is most appropriate?

A) Tell the student to delete every account immediately so the harassment can no longer be seen.

B) Ask the student to keep checking the posts so the full scope of the harassment is understood.

C) Help the student silence alerts, preserve necessary evidence with a chosen supportive adult, and decide how and when to access the accounts.

Question 7

> A caregiver misses medical appointments because the available bus route requires three transfers. The caregiver says, "I keep calling myself irresponsible, but I need a plan that actually works."

Which counseling intervention is most appropriate?

A) Challenge the word "irresponsible" until the caregiver reports less guilt.

B) Encourage stronger commitment to the existing route before considering alternatives.

C) Define the transportation problem precisely, brainstorm options without judging them, and evaluate one feasible next action.

Question 8

Which practice best describes an effective counseling paraphrase?

A) Repeating the client's exact words so the original meaning cannot be altered.

B) Restating the essence in concise language and giving the client an opportunity to confirm or correct it.

C) Adding a likely motive that the client has not yet expressed.

Question 9

> A worker witnessed a serious workplace accident in which a colleague was injured. Several hours later, the worker is safe but shaking and saying, "I should have prevented it." Emergency personnel have confirmed that the worker did not cause the accident.

What is the counselor's best response at this stage?

A) Help the worker settle physically, validate the distress, and identify an immediate supportive person or practical need.

B) Challenge the guilt by reviewing every fact proving the worker was not responsible.

C) Ask for a detailed sensory account of the accident so the memory can be processed before the worker leaves.

Question 10

> A client says, "Since my promotion, my spirit feels crowded." The counselor is unfamiliar with the phrase and has several possible interpretations.

What is the counselor's best response?

A) Reflect that the client feels anxious because the promotion created too many demands.

B) Avoid the phrase and ask only about observable changes since the promotion.

C) Ask the client what "my spirit feels crowded" means in the client's own experience.

Question 11

> A client alternates between avoiding concerns with a roommate and expressing them in an explosive way. The client wants to make a clear request without attacking or withdrawing.

Which in-session intervention is most appropriate?

A) Advise the client to send a written complaint so emotional reactions are avoided.

B) Focus on relaxation only and postpone communication practice until anger no longer occurs.

C) Help the client organize the facts, feeling, and specific request, then rehearse the conversation with feedback.

Question 12

Which counselor action most directly supports client empowerment during a crisis response?

A) Selecting the safest reasonable option for the client to reduce decision burden.

B) Providing understandable choices and supporting the client's participation in decisions whenever capacity and safety permit.

C) Withholding uncertain information until professionals have reached complete agreement.

Question 13

> In family counseling, parents praise their 15-year-old as "the responsible one" and rely on the teen to supervise younger siblings every evening. The teen reports exhaustion and falling grades but feels guilty asking for change.

What should the counselor facilitate?

A) Make the caregiving pattern visible, validate the teen's conflict, and help the family redistribute responsibilities in a developmentally appropriate way.

B) Teach the teen more efficient scheduling so the family can preserve the current arrangement.

C) Ask the teen to refuse all future caregiving without discussing the family's needs.

Question 14

> A client has a personalized crisis plan stored in a phone but says, "When I'm overwhelmed, I can't find it or remember whom to call." The client is stable in session and wants to make the plan easier to use.

What should the counselor do?

A) Help the client place the plan and key contacts where they can be reached quickly, then rehearse accessing and following the first step.

B) Ask the client to memorize every contact and coping step before relying on the plan.

C) Keep the only copy of the plan in the clinical record so it cannot be lost.

Question 15

> The counselor becomes tearful while a client describes a family loss. The client stops speaking and begins comforting the counselor. The counselor is able to regain composure.

What is the counselor's best response?

A) Accept the comfort because mutual emotional support can strengthen authenticity.

B) Briefly acknowledge the reaction, clarify that caring for the counselor is not the client's responsibility, and explore the impact on the client.

C) Ignore what happened and return immediately to questions about the family loss.

Question 16

> A client speaks rapidly about work, a parent's illness, financial strain, and conflict with a friend, shifting topics before completing any one of them. The client pauses and says, "I don't even know where to start."

Which counselor response is most helpful?

A) Ask a sequence of closed questions so every problem receives equal assessment time.

B) Choose the issue that appears clinically most serious and begin exploring it without interrupting.

C) Briefly summarize the concerns and ask which one would be most useful to focus on today.

Question 17

> In family counseling, adult siblings begin discussing resentment about unequal caregiving for their mother. One sibling makes a joke, everyone laughs briefly, and the conversation stops. This pattern has occurred twice in the session.

What is the counselor's best response?

A) Join the humor to reduce tension before introducing a different family topic.

B) Note that humor has appeared when caregiving resentment surfaces and invite each person to describe what happens next internally.

C) Ask the joking sibling to remain silent while the other family members discuss the conflict.

Question 18

> A client wants to respond more assertively to a supervisor but reports that coworkers who challenged this supervisor were assigned worse shifts. The client cannot risk losing work hours and is uncomfortable with direct confrontation.

How should the counselor adapt assertiveness work?

A) Explore a range of lower-risk options, such as documenting concerns, consulting a trusted ally, or making a limited request, and let the client choose.

B) Rehearse a direct confrontation because avoiding it will reinforce the client's fear.

C) Advise the client to accept the situation because assertiveness is unsafe in this workplace.

Question 19

> A client says, "When you stay quiet after I answer, it feels cold, like you're testing me." The counselor had intended the silence to provide room for reflection.

What should the counselor do?

A) Acknowledge the impact, clarify the intention briefly, and ask what kind of pacing would feel more supportive.

B) Explain that therapeutic silence is an established counseling skill and encourage the client to tolerate it.

C) Stop using any silence with this client so the issue does not recur.

Question 20

> Several group members blame one member for “making every session tense.” The targeted member becomes quiet, while the others unite around criticism and stop examining their own contributions.

What should the group leader do?

A) Interrupt the scapegoating, describe the group-wide pattern, and invite each member to examine a personal contribution to the tension.

B) Ask the targeted member to explain why multiple people have reached the same conclusion.

C) Let the criticism continue because shared agreement indicates that the group’s feedback is accurate.

Question 21

> A client responds to mistakes with statements such as, “I’m useless and deserve to feel bad.” The client fears that a kinder internal response would eliminate accountability and reduce effort.

Which intervention best addresses this concern?

A) Tell the client that self-criticism is irrational and should be replaced with praise.

B) Avoid self-compassion because the client believes criticism supports performance.

C) Practice a balanced compassionate response that acknowledges the mistake and a corrective action, then compare its effect on motivation with the harsh response.

Question 22

> One partner insists that sharing all phone passwords proves commitment. The other partner experiences the demand as controlling but worries that refusing will be seen as evidence of dishonesty. Both ask the counselor to define what trusting couples should do.

What is the counselor’s best intervention?

A) Recommend password sharing because mutual transparency reduces suspicion.

B) Explore each partner’s meanings of trust, privacy, and safety, then facilitate a mutually consented boundary rather than prescribe one.

C) Recommend separate phones and accounts so the issue cannot affect the relationship.

Question 23

> At an emergency shelter after a severe storm, a client is handed several forms and pages of instructions. The client stares at the papers and says, “I can’t take in any of this.” Immediate safety and basic medical needs have already been addressed.

What should the counselor do?

A) Ask which immediate concern matters most, address one step at a time, and check the client’s understanding before adding information.

B) Read every form aloud so the client receives all available information during the meeting.

C) Set the paperwork aside until the client appears fully calm and requests it independently.

Question 24

> A Native American client says that meeting with a traditional healer is important and asks whether those practices can be used alongside counseling. The client wants to decide what, if anything, is shared between helpers.

How should the counselor respond?

A) Explain that the client must choose one approach so the interventions do not conflict.

B) Explore how the client wants the approaches to complement each other and coordinate only with the client’s informed permission.

C) Contact the healer for cultural guidance before continuing counseling with the client.

Question 25

> During conflict, one partner becomes flooded and goes silent to calm down. The other follows from room to room, interpreting the silence as abandonment. Both want a way to interrupt this cycle without avoiding the issue.

Which intervention should the counselor facilitate?

A) Instruct the silent partner to remain in the conversation until the other feels reassured.

B) Tell the pursuing partner to stop raising concerns that could overwhelm the other.

C) Help the couple rehearse a time-limited pause that includes a clear statement of when they will return to the conversation.

Question 26

When is a structured round especially useful in group counseling?

A) When the leader wants every member to agree with a single interpretation.

B) When a focused prompt can help balance participation and briefly hear from each willing member.

C) When one member needs uninterrupted time for an extended individual counseling exchange.

Question 27

What is the primary purpose of an exception question in solution-focused counseling?

A) To determine whether the client is minimizing how often the problem occurs.

B) To identify times the problem is absent or less intense and examine resources associated with those times.

C) To uncover the early experience that originally caused the current problem.

Question 28

> A client wants to stop escalating minor disagreements into angry outbursts. The client usually notices the problem only after shouting and says, “It happens too fast to change.”

Which in-session intervention would be most useful?

A) Ask the client to suppress angry thoughts as soon as an argument begins.

B) Focus exclusively on the consequences of past outbursts to increase motivation.

C) Map a recent episode step by step to identify triggers, early body cues, actions, and points for a different response.

Question 29

> A client who lives in the same small community as the counselor asks for the counselor’s street and the school attended by the counselor’s children. The client says, “It would help me know you understand people like us.”

What is the most appropriate response?

A) Provide the information because shared-community disclosure is necessary for cultural trust.

B) Decline the questions without discussion because any personal inquiry threatens professional boundaries.

C) Explore what the information would mean to the client, explain the privacy limit, and discuss safer ways to address the need for understanding.

Question 30

> A client at a community agency begins shouting after learning that an assistance request was denied. The client is not threatening anyone but repeatedly interrupts and demands that the counselor “fix it now.”

Which response is most likely to support de-escalation?

A) Explain all reasons the request was denied so the client understands the agency’s decision.

B) Tell the client that the meeting will end unless the interruptions stop immediately.

C) Lower the pace, reflect the urgent need behind the anger, and offer a choice between reviewing an appeal step or identifying another resource.

Question 31

A refugee client becomes tense when automated appointment texts arrive and explains that electronic messages from institutions were used for surveillance in the client's country of origin. The clinic offers telephone, email, text, or no automated reminders.

What should the counselor do?

A) Explore the client's concern, explain how reminder information is handled, and let the client choose an acceptable reminder method.

B) Continue texts because repeated neutral messages will gradually correct the client's fear.

C) Disable every electronic service without discussion to protect the client from further distress.

Question 32

What is the main therapeutic function of a minimal encourager such as "Mm-hmm" or "Go on"?

A) To communicate attention and invite the client to continue without directing the content.

B) To indicate that the counselor agrees with the client's interpretation.

C) To move the client toward a topic the counselor considers more important.

Question 33

A 15-year-old begins counseling with a parent present. The parent says, "I expect to hear everything discussed here," and the adolescent looks alarmed. The agency's consent form allows private adolescent sessions and specifies the information that must be disclosed for safety.

What should the counselor do?

A) Promise the adolescent complete confidentiality so honest counseling can begin.

B) Review the confidentiality agreement and its safety limits with both, explain how updates can be handled, and invite questions before proceeding.

C) Ask the parent to leave immediately and discuss confidentiality only with the adolescent.

Question 34

A client has decided to reduce alcohol use at social events rather than pursue abstinence. The client identifies free drinks and lack of transportation as situations that often lead to drinking more than intended.

Which intervention best matches the client's stated goal?

A) Require an abstinence commitment because moderation plans communicate approval of substance use.

B) Focus on why the client is unwilling to choose the goal most likely to eliminate risk.

C) Develop a concrete harm-reduction plan addressing drink limits, nonalcoholic alternatives, and transportation before the event.

PART B — ANSWER KEY AND EXPLANATIONS

Answers match the numbered items in Part A.

Question 1 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Apologize for the jargon, explain the idea in plain language with the client's example, and check whether it makes sense.

Explanation: The counselor takes responsibility for accessible communication and verifies shared understanding without shaming the client. A glossary postpones repair and may preserve the same language barrier.

Question 2 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Review the plan in short sections, connect each step to a likely situation, and ask the client to explain how the steps would be used.

Explanation: Chunking, contextual examples, and client explanation turn written instructions into an actionable plan and reveal misunderstandings. The counselor should not independently replace a clinical discharge plan, and rereading alone does not address the client's processing difficulty.

Question 3 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Help the client plan a manageable form of opposite action, such as attending briefly and engaging with one supportive person.

Explanation: When an emotion-driven urge is not effective in the facts of the situation, a graded opposite action can interrupt avoidance and support a valued activity. Waiting for shame to vanish reinforces withdrawal, and calling the mistake a success is not credible emotional regulation.

Question 4 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: "You have corrected me more than once, and I still got it wrong. I'm sorry. Please help me say it correctly now, and tell me how this has affected you."

Explanation: The counselor accepts responsibility, takes an immediate corrective step, and makes room for the relational impact. Explaining that unfamiliar names are difficult shifts attention to the counselor and can minimize a repeated failure that matters to the client.

Question 5 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Describe the approval-seeking pattern and invite the member and group to explore what happens when the leader does not evaluate each contribution.

Explanation: The intervention uses the here-and-now pattern to reduce leader dependence and restore member-to-member engagement. Reassurance reinforces the pattern, while silent nonresponse without processing may feel punitive and offers little interpersonal learning.

Question 6 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Help the student silence alerts, preserve necessary evidence with a chosen supportive adult, and decide how and when to access the accounts.

Explanation: This approach reduces repeated exposure, preserves options for reporting, and restores the student's control with supportive involvement. Immediate deletion may destroy information and override choice, while continuous monitoring prolongs activation.

Question 7 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Define the transportation problem precisely, brainstorm options without judging them, and evaluate one feasible next action.

Explanation: Structured problem solving targets the actual access barrier and moves from definition to options and action. Cognitive reframing alone does not create transportation, while renewed commitment to an unworkable route ignores the environmental constraint.

Question 8 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Restating the essence in concise language and giving the client an opportunity to confirm or correct it.

Explanation: A paraphrase condenses the counselor's understanding in fresh language and remains tentative enough for client correction. Verbatim repetition can sound mechanical, while adding an unexpressed motive turns paraphrase into unsupported interpretation.

Question 9 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Help the worker settle physically, validate the distress, and identify an immediate supportive person or practical need.

Explanation: Early crisis support emphasizes stabilization, connection, and immediate needs rather than intensive cognitive or trauma processing. Even accurate factual challenge may be difficult to use while the worker is highly activated, and detailed retelling is not required.

Question 10 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Ask the client what "my spirit feels crowded" means in the client's own experience.

Explanation: Client language should be understood from the client's frame of reference, especially when the counselor is uncertain about an idiom or metaphor. Assigning anxiety and overload may sound plausible but risks replacing the client's meaning with the counselor's assumption.

Question 11 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Help the client organize the facts, feeling, and specific request, then rehearse the conversation with feedback.

Explanation: A structured interpersonal script plus rehearsal builds a middle path between avoidance and explosive expression. Written complaints may preserve avoidance, and relaxation without communication practice does not teach the requested skill.

Question 12 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Providing understandable choices and supporting the client's participation in decisions whenever capacity and safety permit.

Explanation: Empowerment preserves meaningful involvement and informed choice even when a crisis narrows available options. Automatically deciding for the client can unnecessarily remove control at a time when restoring agency may support stabilization.

Question 13 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Make the caregiving pattern visible, validate the teen's conflict, and help the family redistribute responsibilities in a developmentally appropriate way.

Explanation: The intervention addresses the family structure maintaining the teen's exhaustion while acknowledging loyalty and guilt. Efficiency training leaves the excessive role intact, whereas unilateral refusal ignores the family's practical needs and the value of collaborative change.

Question 14 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Help the client place the plan and key contacts where they can be reached quickly, then rehearse accessing and following the first step.

Explanation: Environmental access and behavioral rehearsal make the crisis plan more usable under cognitive strain. Memorizing the entire plan adds unnecessary burden, and a plan stored only in the record is unavailable when the client needs it.

Question 15 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Briefly acknowledge the reaction, clarify that caring for the counselor is not the client's responsibility, and explore the impact on the client.

Explanation: The counselor reestablishes the therapeutic roles and makes space for any burden, discomfort, or meaning created by the visible emotion. Accepting care reverses roles, while ignoring the event leaves the client alone with its impact.

Question 16 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Briefly summarize the concerns and ask which one would be most useful to focus on today.

Explanation: A concise summary organizes the material and returns choice about session focus to the client. The counselor should not assume which issue deserves priority when the client can participate in selecting a workable focus.

Question 17 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Note that humor has appeared when caregiving resentment surfaces and invite each person to describe what happens next internally.

Explanation: The counselor tentatively identifies a repeated process and invites family members to explore its function and emotional consequences. Joining the joke would continue the avoidance, while silencing one member would personalize a family-wide pattern.

Question 18 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Explore a range of lower-risk options, such as documenting concerns, consulting a trusted ally, or making a limited request, and let the client choose.

Explanation: Assertiveness work should account for credible power and economic consequences rather than equate direct confrontation with progress. A range of graded options preserves agency and skill development without denying the workplace risk.

Question 19 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Acknowledge the impact, clarify the intention briefly, and ask what kind of pacing would feel more supportive.

Explanation: Therapeutic techniques are effective only as experienced in the particular relationship, so the counselor responds to impact and seeks collaborative adjustment. Defending silence as an established skill privileges theory over client feedback, while eliminating it forever is unnecessarily absolute.

Question 20 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Interrupt the scapegoating, describe the group-wide pattern, and invite each member to examine a personal contribution to the tension.

Explanation: The leader protects the targeted member and redirects the group from collective blame toward shared process responsibility. Majority agreement does not make scapegoating therapeutically useful or establish that one person causes the entire group dynamic.

Question 21 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Practice a balanced compassionate response that acknowledges the mistake and a corrective action, then compare its effect on motivation with the harsh response.

Explanation: The intervention addresses the client's concern empirically by combining accountability with compassion and observing motivational effects. Empty praise would not be credible, while avoiding the method leaves the belief that cruelty is necessary untested.

Question 22 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Explore each partner's meanings of trust, privacy, and safety, then facilitate a mutually consented boundary rather than prescribe one.

Explanation: The counselor helps the couple examine needs and negotiate consent without declaring a universal rule for intimacy. Prescribing password sharing could validate coercion, while technological separation alone would not resolve the underlying meanings.

Question 23 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Ask which immediate concern matters most, address one step at a time, and check the client's understanding before adding information.

Explanation: Acute stress can reduce information processing, so prioritization, small chunks, and comprehension checks make support usable. Reading everything aloud preserves the overload, while withholding all information removes access to resources the client may need now.

Question 24 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Explore how the client wants the approaches to complement each other and coordinate only with the client's informed permission.

Explanation: This response respects the client's cultural resources, autonomy, and control over information sharing. Contacting the healer without permission violates the client's stated preference, while requiring a choice between approaches imposes an unnecessary division.

Question 25 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Help the couple rehearse a time-limited pause that includes a clear statement of when they will return to the conversation.

Explanation: A structured pause addresses physiological flooding without turning withdrawal into indefinite avoidance or abandonment. A stated return time gives the pursuing partner predictability while both partners practice interrupting the cycle.

Question 26 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: When a focused prompt can help balance participation and briefly hear from each willing member.

Explanation: A round provides structure and broad access to participation around a defined question while allowing members to pass. It is not designed to manufacture agreement or create an extended individual session within the group.

Question 27 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: To identify times the problem is absent or less intense and examine resources associated with those times.

Explanation: Exception questions help clients notice existing strengths, contextual differences, and behaviors linked to better moments. They are not primarily tools for testing honesty or tracing a problem to its origin.

Question 28 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Map a recent episode step by step to identify triggers, early body cues, actions, and points for a different response.

Explanation: A detailed behavior chain slows the sequence and identifies earlier intervention points that the client currently misses. Thought suppression is unlikely to teach regulation, and consequences alone do not reveal where a different response can be inserted.

Question 29 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Explore what the information would mean to the client, explain the privacy limit, and discuss safer ways to address the need for understanding.

Explanation: The counselor maintains personal and family privacy while treating the request as meaningful rather than simply rejecting it. Exploring the underlying need can lead to appropriate ways of building cultural trust without disclosing identifying details.

Question 30 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Lower the pace, reflect the urgent need behind the anger, and offer a choice between reviewing an appeal step or identifying another resource.

Explanation: This response validates the core concern, reduces interactional intensity, and offers limited productive choices. A detailed policy explanation is hard to process during high arousal, while an immediate ultimatum may intensify the power struggle when no threat is present.

Question 31 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Explore the client's concern, explain how reminder information is handled, and let the client choose an acceptable reminder method.

Explanation: The counselor links the present reaction to the client's stated context, provides transparent information, and preserves choice among available methods. Continuing texts as involuntary exposure dismisses the surveillance history, while disabling everything without consultation also removes agency.

Question 32 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: To communicate attention and invite the client to continue without directing the content.

Explanation: Minimal encouragers convey presence while leaving the client in control of what comes next. They do not necessarily signal agreement and should not covertly steer the client toward the counselor's preferred topic.

Question 33 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Review the confidentiality agreement and its safety limits with both, explain how updates can be handled, and invite questions before proceeding.

Explanation: Clear orientation creates realistic expectations and supports trust for both adolescent and parent under the stated agency arrangement. Promising total secrecy is inaccurate, while removing the parent before explaining the framework can intensify confusion and conflict.

Question 34 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Develop a concrete harm-reduction plan addressing drink limits, nonalcoholic alternatives, and transportation before the event.

Explanation: The client has chosen a reduction goal and identified predictable risk conditions, so a specific plan can lower harm and support self-monitoring. Imposing abstinence would override the stated goal and may reduce engagement.
